

Lesson 15

1. ～としたら・～とすれば・～とすると／～となったら・～となれば・～となると

Meaning & Nuance

If we suppose that... / Assuming that... / If it were the case that...

Used to imagine a situation and consider what would happen or what one would think in that situation.

～としたら・～とすれば・～とすると → stronger sense of a hypothetical assumption.

～となったら・～となれば・～となると → used when the situation has a real possibility of actually happening, and we consider what would happen if it does.

Both are generally followed by the speaker's judgment, conclusion, prediction, etc. With ～とすると and ～となると, the following clause does not normally express the speaker's wish, intention, request, command, or invitation.

例：

1. もし一億円当たったとしたら、何に使いますか。
2. 彼の話が本当だとすれば、大きな問題になるだろう。
3. 来月日本へ行くとなったら、早くホテルを予約しなければならない。
4. 会社を辞めるとなると、これからの生活を考えなければならない。

2. ～ものなら

Meaning & Nuance

If one could... / If it were possible to...

Used to imagine something that is difficult or almost impossible to realize, followed by what the speaker would like to do or wishes could happen.

Often carries the feeling: "If only that were possible..."

It makes a hypothetical assumption about something that seems unlikely or impossible. It is usually preceded by a verb expressing possibility, and followed by the speaker's wish or hope.

例：

1. できるものなら、もう一度彼に会いたい。
2. 帰れるものなら、今すぐ国へ帰りたい。
3. 忘れられるものなら、全部忘れてしまいたい。

Difference from ～としたら

～としたら → simply supposes a situation and considers what would happen.

一億円あったとしたら、何をしますか。

Suppose you had 100 million yen. What would you do?

～ものなら → the situation is considered difficult/unrealistic, often with a strong wish.

一億円もらえるものなら、世界旅行をしたい。

If I could somehow get 100 million yen, I'd like to travel around the world.

3. ～（よ）うものなら

If one were to... / If something were to happen...

Used when imagining that if something undesirable or risky happened, it would lead to a serious/bad consequence.

The nuance is: "If that were to happen, there would be trouble."

So ～ようものなら strongly emphasizes the dangerous or serious consequence of doing something.

例：

1. そんなことを彼に言おうものなら、きっと怒るだろう。
2. この秘密が会社に知られようものなら、大問題になる。

3. 試験中に携帯電話を使おうものなら、すぐ失格になるだろう。

Difference from ～ものなら

～ものなら → If it were possible... → difficult/impossible condition + wish/hope

できるものなら、もう一度やり直したい。

If I could, I'd like to start over.

～ようものなら → If one were to... → hypothetical action + serious/undesirable consequence

失敗しようものなら、大変なことになる。

If we were to fail, it would be a serious problem.

4. ～ないことには

Unless... / Without doing...

Used when one condition must be fulfilled first; otherwise, the next thing cannot happen or cannot be decided.

“Unless X happens/is done, Y is impossible.”

A sentence with a negative meaning comes after it.

The second result cannot happen, cannot be known, or cannot be achieved unless the first condition is satisfied.

例：

1. 実際に見てみないことには、買うかどうか決められない。
2. 本人に聞かないことには、本当のことはわからない。
3. もっと練習しないことには、試合には勝てない。

5. ～を抜きにしては

Without... / If we leave out...

Used to say that without something essential or important, another thing cannot happen or cannot be achieved.

X is considered indispensable for Y. "Without X, Y would be impossible."

It attaches to words referring to something the speaker highly values. It is followed by a sentence meaning that something cannot be realized.

The speaker considers X important or essential, and emphasizes that the result would not be possible without X.

例：

1. 彼女抜きでは、このプロジェクトは成功しなかっただろう。
2. 社長抜きでは会議は始められません。
3. 田中先生の協力を抜きにしては、この計画は実現できない。

⑥ ～としても・～にしても・～にしろ・～にせよ

Even if... / Even though... / No matter whether...

Used to say that even if a certain condition or fact is true, it does not change the speaker's judgment, opinion, or decision.

"Regardless of X, my conclusion remains the same."

With ～としても, the first clause is usually hypothetical.

With ～にしても・～にしろ・～にせよ, the first clause can be either hypothetical or an actual fact.

These expressions are often used with question words (何・誰・どこ etc.). The second clause usually expresses the speaker's judgment, opinion, evaluation, or feeling.

例：

1. たとえ失敗するとしても、一度挑戦してみたい。
2. 忙しいにしても、連絡ぐらいはできたはずだ。
3. 何をするにせよ、最後まで責任を持ちなさい。